

One is Not Enough: How People Use Multiple AI Models in Everyday Life

Seunghwa Pyo*, Donggun Lee*, Jungwoo Rhee*, Soobin Park, Youn-kyung Lim
Department of Industrial Design, KAIST, Republic of Korea

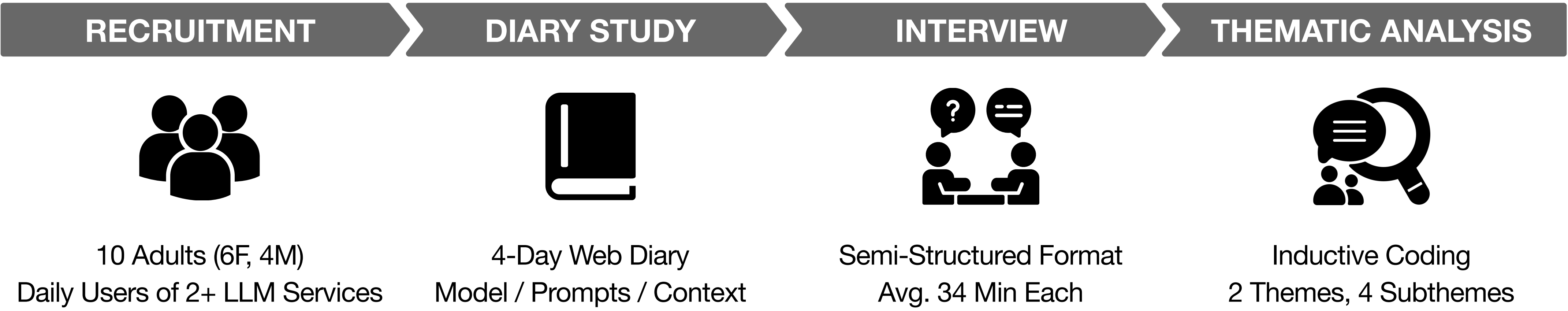
This work was supported by the National Research Foundation of Korea (NRF) grant funded by the Korea government (MSIT) (No. RS-2021-NR059056).



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What motivated this study?

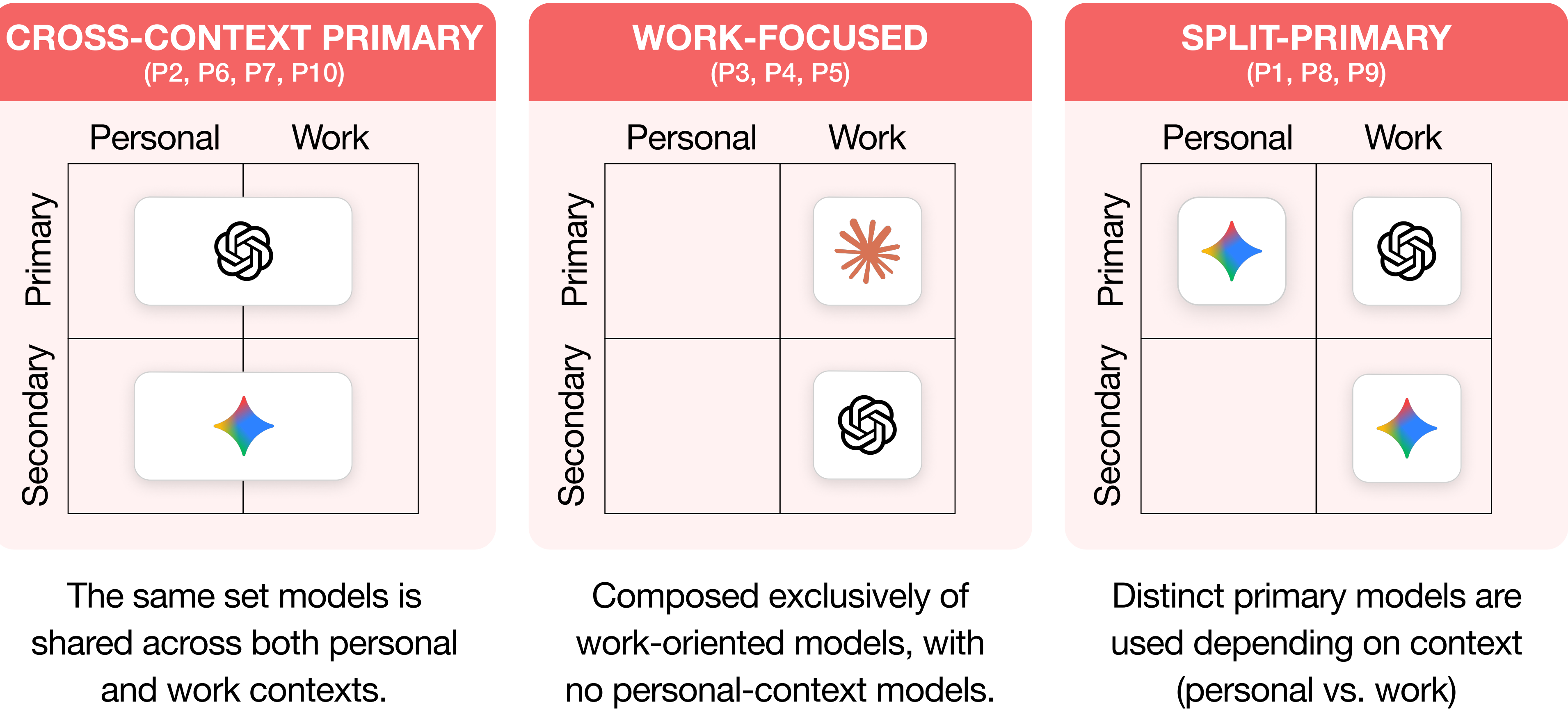
✦ An important challenge in using multiple AI models is **understanding how people can effectively coordinate multiple models**, as using more models does not necessarily lead to better outcomes. **Empirical studies** remain limited on how people use multiple LLM services in practice.



Finding 1: Individuals establish personal LLM service hierarchies

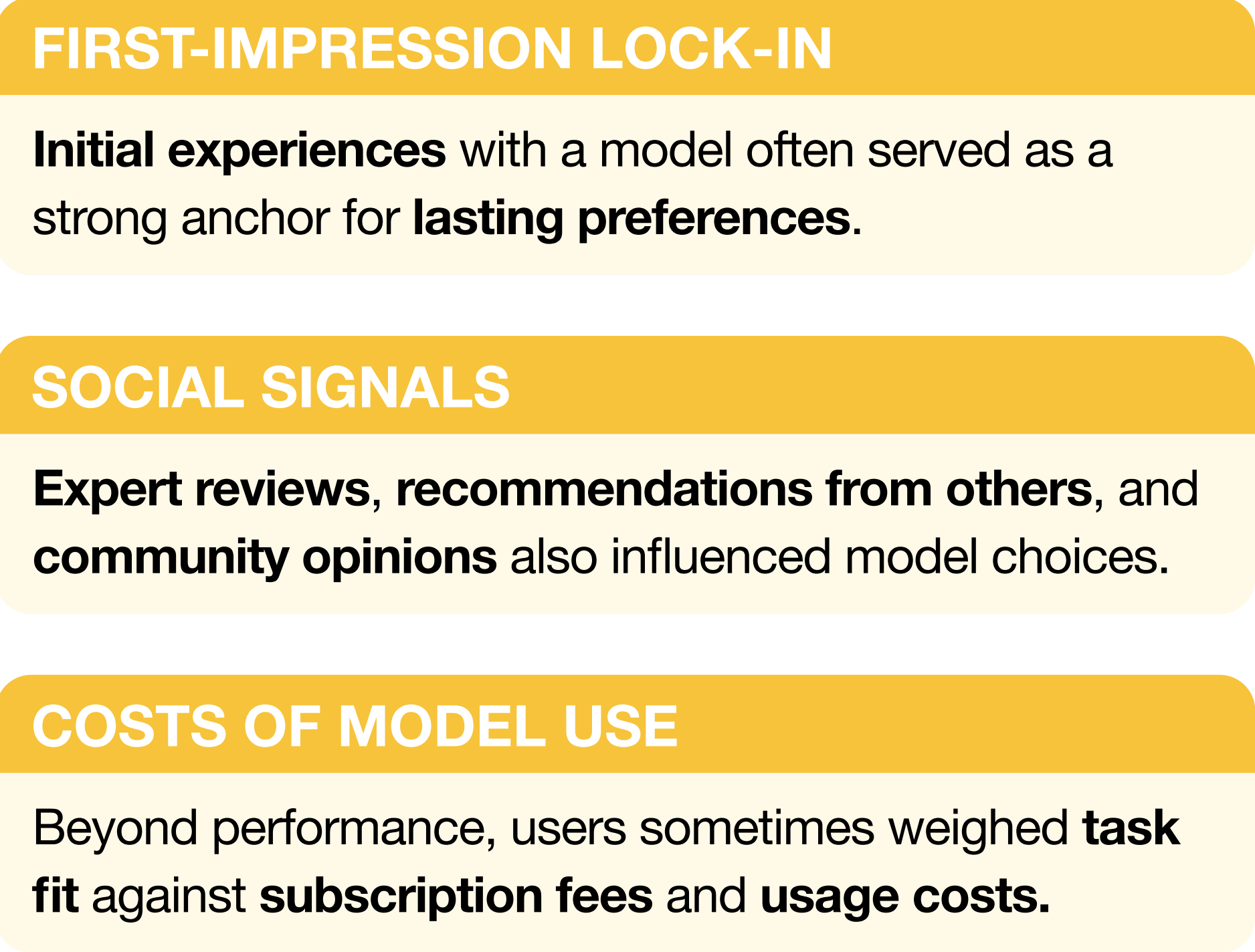
✦ Users maintain **primary AI models**, supported by **secondary models**, with roles shifting across personal and professional contexts.

1.1 Three Recurring Hierarchy Patterns



1.2 Factors Shaping the Hierarchies

Personal hierarchies are dynamically reconfigured based on **three key factors**:

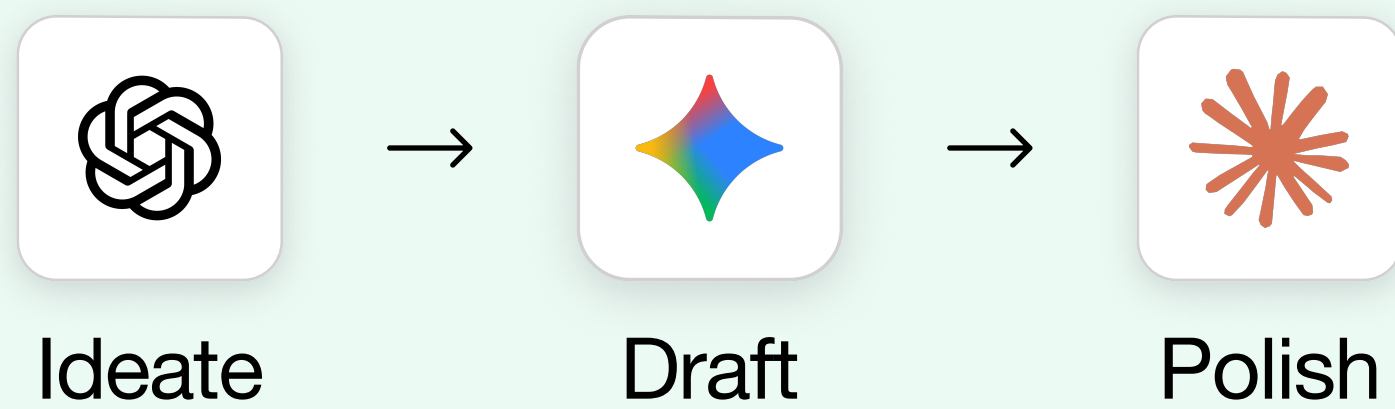


Finding 2. Strategies for Coordinating Multiple LLM Services

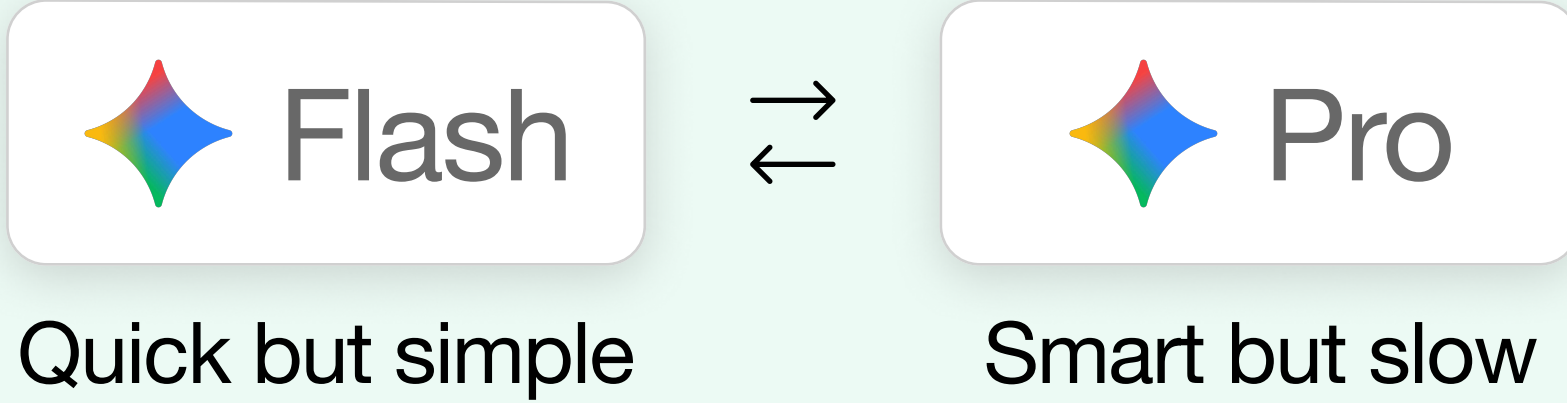
✦ Users **strategically switch** models or **iterate within a model** to improve outcomes.

2.1 Strategic Model Switching

ROLE ASSIGNMENT (P2, P5, P6, P7, P9)
Different task stages were assigned to different models based on strengths.

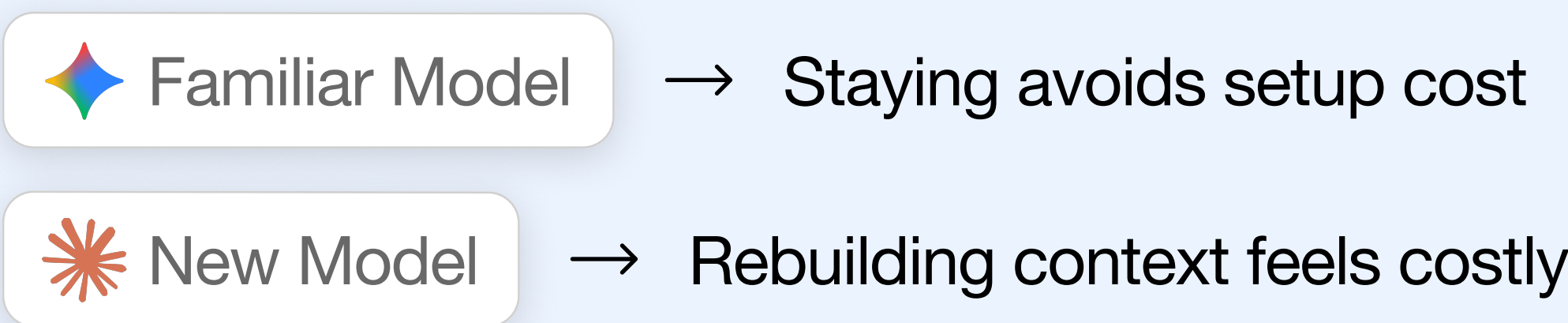


EFFORT MANAGEMENT (P1, P5, P9)
Model switching was used to match **task difficulty** and optimize efficiency.



2.2 Don't Migrate, Iterate Instead

NOT RESETTNG THE RELATIONSHIP (P2, P4, P6, P10)
Rebuilding personal context in another model often felt **more costly** than any likely performance gain.



BLAME THE PROMPT, NOT THE MODEL (P1, P8, P9)
Poor outputs often led to **prompt refinement** rather than model switching.

